Worth County, Iowa

COUNTY DATA BRIEF | Published response: Continue routine review | Design prototype

What the data show The Atlas displays a light-blue published response category for Worth County. Published county-level 2023 Lyme case, tick-presence, and *Borrelia burgdorferi* detection records are unavailable. These gaps warrant careful interpretation, not a conclusion of zero cases, absent ticks, or local transmission.

County data / Six review factors

01 Published Lyme case data

No county-level 2023 Lyme case count was published. Missing does not mean zero. Explorer also notes **77 statewide 2023 records unallocated to counties**; none may be attributed to Worth County without confirmation.

02 Tick presence

The published county tick table contains no record for Worth County. A missing record does **not** establish that ticks are absent.

03 Borrelia burgdorferi detection

No published county-level pathogen detection record is available. This does not establish that the pathogen is absent or that testing was negative.

04 Social vulnerability

The displayed 2022 SVI percentile is **2.3**. This describes community context; it does not establish Lyme transmission or case underreporting.

05 Health insurance coverage

The displayed uninsured percentage is **5.9%**. This informs healthcare-access context and is not proof that cases are missed.

06 Rurality

USDA 2023 Rural–Urban Continuum Code **9**: completely rural or fewer than 2,500 urban residents, not adjacent to a metro area. Useful for program context, not a tick-habitat or underreporting measure.

Interpreting the data: Lyme cases are assigned by county of residence, not necessarily location of exposure. These data describe published surveillance, not individual risk. Review rationale does not quantify how much each factor contributed to the score.

Source periods visible in Explorer: Lyme case records 2023; SVI 2022; rurality 2023. Actual gap score, release identifier, and uninsured-source vintage must be populated from the governed export—not guessed from screenshots.

Continue routine review

COUNTY DATA BRIEF | Worth County, Iowa | Published gap-score response

Recommended posture: Maintain established surveillance. Do not initiate additional investigation solely because a county has an Atlas score. The suggestions below do not establish individual risk or prove underreporting.

Five suggested follow-up workstreams

Human disease surveillance	Continue routine review through established processes. Note the missing published county count; consult local records, including suppressed or unallocated reports, as appropriate. Statewide unallocated records cannot be assigned to this county without verification.
Vector and pathogen surveillance	Review new surveillance findings through established activities. No county tick or matching pathogen record is published; missing is not absent and does not alone justify new field sampling.
Clinical and laboratory reporting	Maintain awareness of reporting practices. Examine clinical or laboratory pathways if local records raise a specific question; the Atlas does not indicate that reporting failed.
Community context and outreach	Continue locally appropriate prevention education. Use available SVI, insurance and rurality measures as planning context—not evidence of transmission or underreporting.
Coordination and documentation	Document data limitations and items to revisit in routine review. Consult epidemiology or vector-program colleagues as needed; no assignment, deadline or escalation is implied.

Questions before acting

01 Are current surveillance processes sufficient to review this county as new data become available?

02 Are gaps in the published human or vector evidence best documented for future review?

03 Do available local records suggest a reason to depart from established monitoring practices?

04 Are current prevention and communication activities appropriate for the community context already known?

Official resources & traceability

CDC Lyme case definition | CDC tick surveillance datasets | CDC clinical testing | CDC prevention

Production export requirement: Insert verified FIPS, current score/color, data-release and methodology identifiers, generated timestamp, data observation periods, and accessible source links. This prototype is based on supplied Worth County screenshots and is not a validated current assessment.